Issa Sugiura

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PhD Student, Institute of Science Tokyo

sugiura.i.d1a6@m.isct.ac.jp | speed1313.github.io | speed1313 | Scholar | speed1313

Research Interests

My research focuses on building **data resources**, namely training datasets and benchmarks, and on using them to develop **vision-language models (VLMs)** and to **benchmark LLM agents** on economically valuable, long-horizon tasks beyond coding and math.

Education

Apr 2026 – present	**Doctor of Engineering** Course of Artificial Intelligence, Dept. of Computer Science, School of Computing (Expected)	Institute of Science Tokyo, Japan
Apr 2024 – Mar 2026	**Master of Informatics** Course of Communications and Computer Engineering, Graduate School of Informatics	Kyoto University, Japan
Apr 2020 – Mar 2024	**Bachelor of Engineering** Software Science Course, Dept. of Information and Computer Sciences, School of Engineering Science GPA 3.57/4.00	Osaka University, Japan

Experience

Apr 2026 – present	**Research Assistant** Research on vision-language models.	Institute of Science Tokyo, Japan
Dec 2024 – present	**Student Intern** Building benchmarks with domain experts to evaluate LLM agents on economically valuable, long-horizon tasks, including financial analysis (EDINET-Bench, ICLR 2026) and multi-agent economies (CoffeeBench, NeurIPS 2026).	Sakana AI, Japan
Feb 2024 – present	**Research Assistant** Developing Japanese vision-language models across the full pipeline: large-scale dataset construction (WAON, Jagle), evaluation benchmark design (JAMMEval, HakushoBench), and model training (LLM-jp-4-VL).	National Institute of Informatics, Japan

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. **CoffeeBench: Benchmarking Long-Horizon LLM Agents in Heterogeneous Multi-Agent Economies**
   I. Sugiura, D. Hattori, K. Araragi, K. Ogawa, S. Onose, T. Makino, T. Usuki, T. Ishida
   NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations and Datasets Track Paper Code Blog
2. **Harbor Adapters and Harbor-Index: Infrastructure and a Curated Meta-Dataset for Large-Scale Agentic Evaluation**
   L. Shi et al. (incl. **I. Sugiura**; 126 authors)
   NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations and Datasets Track Paper
3. **HakushoBench: A Japanese Chart and Table VQA Benchmark from Governmental White Papers**
   I. Sugiura, S. Kurita, Y. Oda, N. Okazaki
   AACL-IJCNLP 2026 Findings Paper Code Dataset
4. **WAON: A Large-Scale Japanese Image-Text Dataset for Cultural Adaptation in Contrastive VLMs**
   I. Sugiura, S. Kurita, Y. Oda, D. Kawahara, Y. Okabe, N. Okazaki
   AACL-IJCNLP 2026 Findings Paper Code Dataset
   → Largest-scale Japanese image-text dataset (155M pairs)
5. **Jagle: Building a Large-Scale Japanese Multimodal Post-Training Dataset for VLMs**
   I. Sugiura, K. Sasagawa, K. Nakao, K. Maeda, Z. Yin, Z. Yang, S. Kurita, Y. Oda, R. Tokuhisa, D. Kawahara, N. Okazaki
   COLM 2026 Paper Code Dataset Model
   → Largest-scale Japanese multimodal post-training dataset (9.2M examples)
6. **Cross-Task Evaluation and Empirical Analysis of Japanese Visual Language Models**
   K. Maeda, **I. Sugiura**, Y. Oda, S. Kurita, N. Okazaki
   Journal of Natural Language Processing, June 2026 Paper Code
7. **EDINET-Bench: Evaluating LLMs on Complex Financial Tasks using Japanese Financial Statements**
   I. Sugiura, T. Ishida, T. Makino, C. Tazuke, T. Nakagawa, K. Nakago, D. Ha
   ICLR 2026 Paper Code Dataset

8. **Removing Mislabeled Data from Trained Models via Machine Unlearning**
   I. Sugiura, S. Okamura, N. Yanai
   IEICE Transactions on Information and Systems, Aug 2025 Paper Code
9. **Developing Japanese CLIP Models Leveraging an Open-weight LLM for Large-scale Dataset Translation**
   I. Sugiura, S. Kurita, Y. Oda, D. Kawahara, N. Okazaki
   NAACL 2025 Student Research Workshop Paper Code
10. **Constructing Multimodal Datasets from Scratch for Rapid Development of a Japanese Visual Language Model**
    K. Sasagawa, K. Maeda, **I. Sugiura**, S. Kurita, N. Okazaki, D. Kawahara
    NAACL 2025 Demo Track Paper Model
11. **A Comprehensive Analysis of Memorization in Large Language Models**
    H. Kiyomaru*, **I. Sugiura***, D. Kawahara, S. Kurohashi (*equal contribution)
    INLG 2024 Paper Code

Preprints

1. **QD-Rec: Open-Ended Evolution of Recommendations via Quality-Diversity**
   T. Ishida, T. Makino, **I. Sugiura**
   arXiv, Oct 2026 Paper Code
2. **JAMMEval: A Refined Collection of Japanese Benchmarks for Reliable VLM Evaluation**
   I. Sugiura, K. Maeda, S. Kurita, Y. Oda, D. Kawahara, N. Okazaki
   arXiv, Apr 2026 Paper Code Dataset
3. **Llama-Mimi: Speech Language Models with Interleaved Semantic and Acoustic Tokens**
   I. Sugiura, S. Kurita, Y. Oda, R. Higashinaka
   arXiv, Sep 2025 Paper Code Model
4. **llm-jp-modernbert: A ModernBERT Model Trained on a Large-Scale Japanese Corpus with Long Context Length**
   I. Sugiura, K. Nakayama, Y. Oda
   arXiv, Apr 2025 Paper Code Model
5. **LLM-jp: A Cross-organizational Project for the Research and Development of Fully Open Japanese LLMs**
   LLM-jp (incl. **I. Sugiura**; 80 authors, alphabetical order)
   arXiv, Jul 2024 Paper

Models / Systems

1. **LLM-jp-4-VL 9B series** 9B Japanese vision-language model extending the Japanese LLM LLM-jp-4 8B Thinking; built with Jagle (largest-scale Japanese multimodal dataset) and RefinedVision (FineVision refined for license & quality issues)
   Model Dataset Blog
2. **simple-evals-mm** Simple and extensible VLM evaluation framework extending OpenAI's simple-evals, supporting Japanese and English multimodal benchmarks
   Code Project Page

Awards & Honors

1. **JSAI Annual Conference Award** JSAI2026, Jun 2026
   Jagle: Building a Large-Scale Japanese Multimodal Post-Training Dataset for VLMs
2. **Best Paper Award** (3/789, top 0.4%) NLP2026, Mar 2026
   Llama-Mimi: Speech Language Models with Interleaved Semantic and Acoustic Tokens
3. **Special Committee Award** (32/748, top 4.3%) NLP2026, Mar 2026
   WAON: Large-Scale and High-Quality Japanese Image-Text Pair Dataset for VLMs
4. **Special Committee Award** (32/726, top 4.4%) NLP2025, Mar 2025
   LLM-jp-3 VILA: Building a Japanese Multimodal Dataset and a Strong Japanese Multimodal Model
5. **LINE Yahoo Sponsor Award** (1/420, top 0.24%) DEIM2024, Feb 2024
   Improving Generalization of Trained Models via Unlearning of Mislabeled Data

Fellowships & Scholarships

1. **Full Repayment Exemption for Outstanding Achievement** Japan Student Services Organization, Jul 2026
   JASSO graduate scholarship
2. **Science Tokyo Support Program for Doctoral Students** Institute of Science Tokyo, Apr 2026
   Doctoral research fellowship (JST SPRING)

Skills

Research	Dataset & benchmark construction, benchmarking, VLM/LLM training
Languages	Japanese (native), English (TOEIC L&R 845, Oct 2025)